# Álvaro Fernández Junquera

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## About me

Postdoctoral researcher in applied economics, labour market policies, and industrial policies. Specialized in public policy evaluation with causal inference and machine learning skills.

## Experience

**Barcelona Supercomputing Center** — Nov 2024-Present
*Postdoctoral researcher* — Barcelona, Spain

- AI4Science fellowship
- Research on the application of machine learning models to public policy

**University of Barcelona** — Dec 2024-Sep 2025
*Substitute professor* — Barcelona, Spain

- Teaching section of Econometrics and Statistics

**Autonomous University of Barcelona** — Oct 2020-Oct 2024
*Predoctoral researcher* — Barcelona, Spain

- Research and teaching position funded by the Ministry of Universities of Spain
- Research stays at the University of Munich and the University of Buenos Aires

## Education

**University of Padova** — Padova, Italy
*PhD in Economics* — Oct 2024

- Research field: labour economics, public policy evaluation
- International cotutelle agreement with the Autonomous University of Barcelona
- Doctoral thesis: "Active labour market policies: effects and predictions for policy design"

**University of Granada** — Granada, Spain
*Master in Economics, 8.11/10* — Oct 2019-Sep 2020

- Specialized in econometrics and macroeconomics, 2 courses with distinction
- Master's thesis about the effectiveness of fiscal stimuli on employment

**University of Granada** — Granada, Spain
*Bachelor in Political Science, 9.39/10* — Sep 2015-Jun 2019

- Specialized in public policies and political theory, 26 courses with distinction
- Bachelor's thesis on liberal egalitarian political theories

**Pompeu Fabra University** — Barcelona, Spain
*Bachelor in Political Science, exchange student* — Sep 2017-Jun 2018

## Publications

**Junquera, Á. F. and Kern, C. (2025)**. From rules to forests: rule-based versus statistical models for jobseeker profiling. *Journal for Labor Market Research, 59*(1), 1-27. [Paper]

**Godino, A. and Junquera, Á. F. (2025)**. Outsourcing and time-related dimensions of job quality: Evidence from the facility management business. In F. P. García-Márquez (Ed.), *Outsourcing: Cases and Studies in Using Operations Research and Management Science Methods*. Springer. [Paper]

**Junquera, Á. F. (2024)**. Las políticas activas de empleo en el marco de las políticas de empleo. *Anuario IET de Trabajo y Relaciones Laborales, 10*, e124-e124. [Paper]

**Junquera, Á. F. (2024)**. El diseño de los subsidios al empleo del Servei Públic d'Ocupació de Catalunya (2016-2018). In S. Pérez de Guzmán and M. Iglesias (Coords.), *Precariedades laborales y desigualdades de género en Iberoamérica*. Dykinson. [Paper]

**Junquera, Á. F. (2024)**. Efectos de la asistencia en la búsqueda de empleo: una revisión sistemática para España. *Gestión y Análisis de Políticas Públicas, 35*, 7-25. Instituto Nacional de Administración Pública. [Paper]

## Working papers

**Junquera, Á. F. (2025)**. Which companies use employment subsidies for young workers? [Paper]

**Junquera, Á. F. (2024)**. More money, more effect? Employment effects of job search services of different intensity. [Paper]

## Grants and awards

**Research grant** | *Fundación Banco Sabadell* — Jun 2023-Jun 2024

**FPU complementary grant for mobility** | *Ministry of Universities of Spain* — Sep 2022-Nov 2022

**Beca Luis Toharia** | *Asociación Española de Economía del Trabajo* — Jun 2022

**Erasmus+ Internships** | *Autonomous University of Barcelona* — Jun 2022-Jul 2022

**Research initiation grant** | *University of Granada* — Apr 2021-Feb 2022

**FPU grant** | *Ministry of Universities of Spain* — Nov 2020-Nov 2024. Funding for the whole predoctoral period, ranked 15 out of 226 candidates

**AUIP grant for Iberoamerican Universities** | *AUIP* — Nov 2021. Funding for a research stay in the Department of Economics of the University of Buenos Aires

**Extraordinary end-of-degree award in the 2015-2019 promotion of Political Science** | *UGR* — Feb 2020

**Award for excellence in university academic performance** | *UGR-Caja Rural* — Feb 2020. Branch of Business and Legal Sciences

**CICODE grant for international volunteering** | *CICODE (UGR)* — May 2019

**Collaboration grant for research initiation** | *Ministry of Education, Spain* — Nov 2018-Jun 2019

**Best academic records in the 2015/2016 & 2016/2017 academic years** | *UGR* — Feb 2017 & Feb 2018

## Conferences and workshops

**(2026) XVIII Labour Economics Meeting (AEET)**: Oral communication.

**(2025) IV Workshop on International Trends in Economic Research (WINTER)**: Oral communication.

**(2024) XXIX Conference of the Italian Association of Labour Economics**: Oral communication.

**(2024) XVI Labour Economics Meeting (AEET)**: Oral communication.

**(2024) I Workshop on Comparative Social and Public Policy**: Oral communication.

**(2023) II Conference of R and XIII Workshop for R Users**: Oral communication.

**(2023) V Annual Conference of Experimental Sociology**: Oral communication.

**(2022) XV Labour Economics Meeting (AEET)**: Oral communication.

**(2022) XIV Spanish Congress of Sociology**: Oral communication.

**(2021) II Workshop 'Experimentation: Society and Politics'**: Oral communication.

**(2021) XV European Sociological Association Conference**: Oral communication.

## Research projects and contracts

**2026-**: ESEC - Effective Subsidies for Employment Creation. Call: Social Research Call 2026 ("la Caixa" Foundation). Amount: €114,892.58 (PI: Caterina Calsamiglia, BSC).

**2026-**: AI4SOCIAL+ - AI Readiness for Social Impact. Call: HORIZON-INFRA-2025-01-EOSC-03 - Advancing AI-readiness and Machine-Actionability in the EOSC Ecosystem (European Commission). Amount: €7,486,799.08 (Coordinator: BSC).

**2025-**: SHAPE - Strategies for Human capital Advancement and Productive Employment. Call: Proyectos Generacion de Conocimiento 2024 (Ministerio de Ciencia, ES). Amount: €163,000 (PI: Caterina Calsamiglia, BSC).

**2023-2024**: Good practices to tackle young unemployment: An analysis of the European experience. Research contract founded by the Public Employment Service of Catalonia. (PI: Óscar Molina, UAB).

**2021-2022**: PerfilaSP - Analysis of sociological and psychological variables as predictors of employability for the profiling of the Public Employment Service of Catalonia. Call: Subvenciones a trabajos de investigación sobre Administración pública y políticas

públicas 2021 (EAPC, CAT). Amount: €12,000 (PI: Óscar Molina, UAB). [Policy report]

**2021**: Design, implementation, and impact evaluation of the Reempresa-SOC program. Research contract founded by the Public Employment Service of Catalonia. (PI: Joan Miquel Verd, UAB). [Policy report]

## Teaching

**2024/2025**: Lecturer of *Statistical Techniques for Social Research* (6 ECTS). Bachelor in Political Science (UB). 60 hours of instruction.

**2024/2025, 2025/2026**: Lecturer of *Comparative Employment Policies in the European Union* (6 ECTS). Master's Degree in Social Policy, Employment and Welfare (UAB). 4 hours and 2 hours of instruction.

**2023/2024, 2024/2025**: Workshop Lecturer of *Qualitative Evaluation Techniques* (4 ECTS). Specialization Diploma in Evaluation of labour market policies (UB). 3 hours of instruction.

**2024/2025**: Workshop Lecturer of *Monitoring and indicators* (4 ECTS). Specialization Diploma in Evaluation of labour market policies (UB). 3 hours of instruction.

**2023/2024**: Teaching Assistant of *Multivariable Data Analysis* (6 ECTS). Bachelor's in Sociology, year 3 (UAB). 12 hours of instruction.

**2022/2023, 2021/2022, 2020/2021**: Teaching Assistant of *Data Analysis* (6 ECTS). Bachelor's in Criminology, year 2 (UAB). Taught using R. 20.5 hours (22/23), 22 hours (21/22), and 14 hours (20/21) of instruction.

## Other education

**2020-2024**: Program of higher education teaching (FDES), UAB (87 hours).

**2023**: Machine learning for social sciences, RECSM-UPF (12 hours).

**2021**: Attention to university students with specific educational needs, accessibility of teaching-learning material and universal design for learning, UAB (12 hours).

**2021**: Competence assessment strategies in hybrid learning environments, UAB (6 hours).

**2021**: Experiments in the study of public opinion, RECSM-UPF (12 hours).

## Other skills

**Languages**: English (C1), German (B1), Spanish (native).

**Programming languages**: R, Python, STATA, Bash.

**Publishing software**: LaTeX, Markdown, Quarto.

## References

**Enrico Rettore**: Full Professor of Econometrics at the University of Padova.

**Henry Aray**: Associate Professor of Economics at the University of Granada.

**Christoph Kern**: Junior Professor of Social Data Science and Statistical Learning at the LMU - University of Munich.